

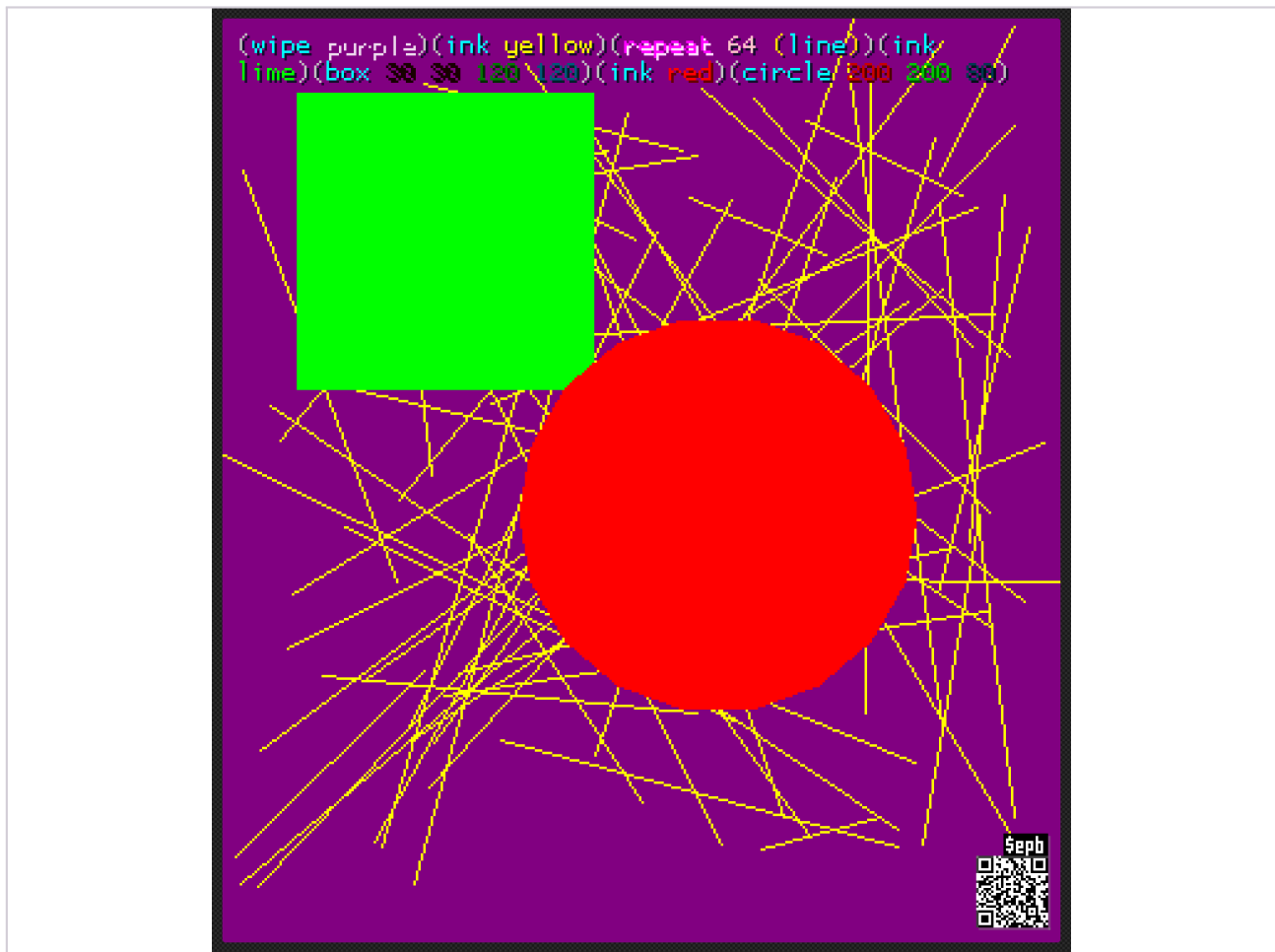
selected work

Jeffrey Alan Scudder

Aesthetic Computer — a creative computing commons

A runtime, an operating system, and a social network for creative computing, built and given away over six years. People make pieces in JavaScript or KidLisp, alongside paintings, tapes, and chats — each living at a web address anyone can open — and a surplus laptop boots into the whole thing in about seven seconds. The five works that follow trace the commons from a single piece down to the bare metal, and back out to the people who gather around it.

aesthetic.computer · Serpentine FAE Fellowship — Art × Convergence · 2026

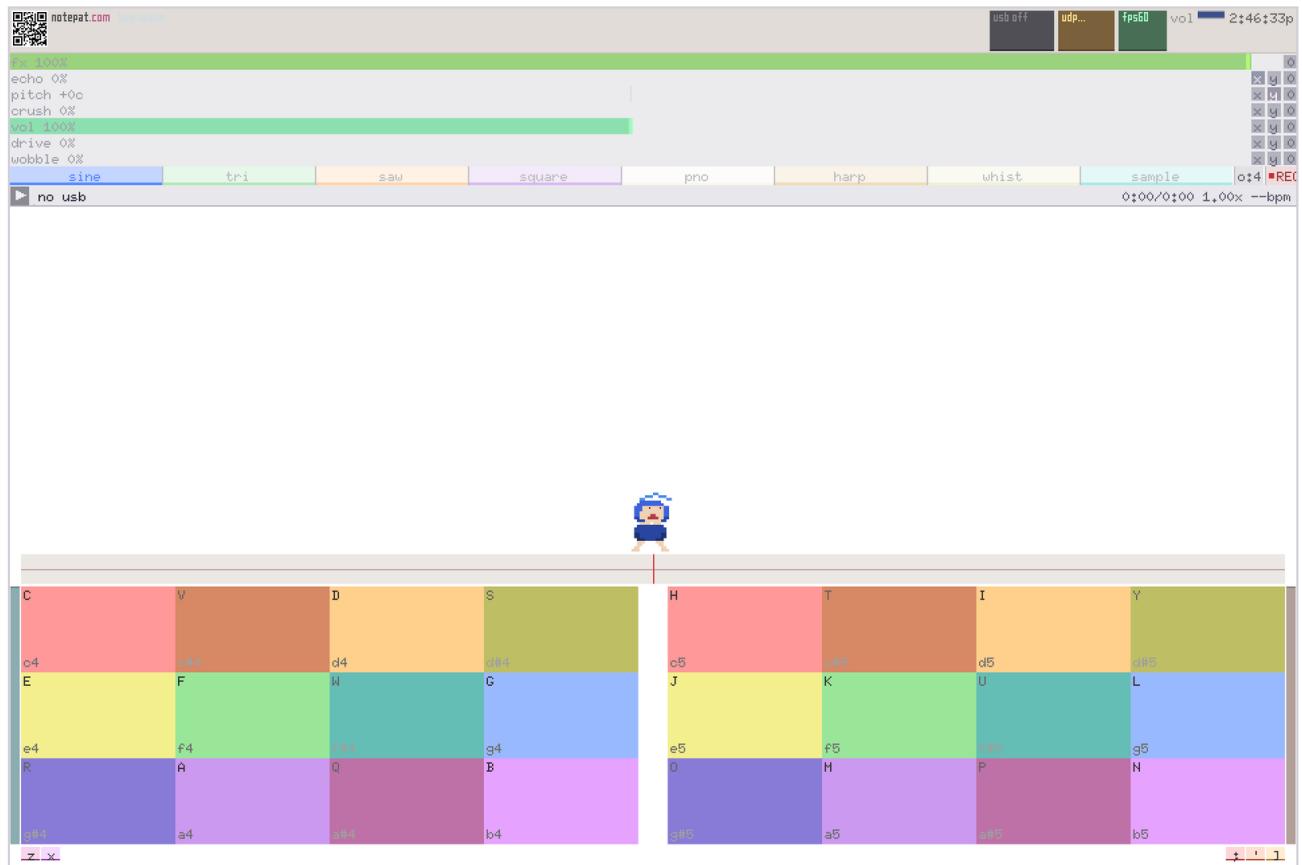


Aesthetic Computer the system / a KidLisp piece · 2020–

author

aesthetic.computer

A runtime, OS, and social network where artists make pieces in JavaScript or KidLisp, alongside paintings, tapes, and chats — each living at a shareable web address. The piece shown is live KidLisp: its source, its rendered output, and the short \$code that lets anyone open it are all on screen at once. This is the cultural commons the proposal sets out to re-found and sustain.

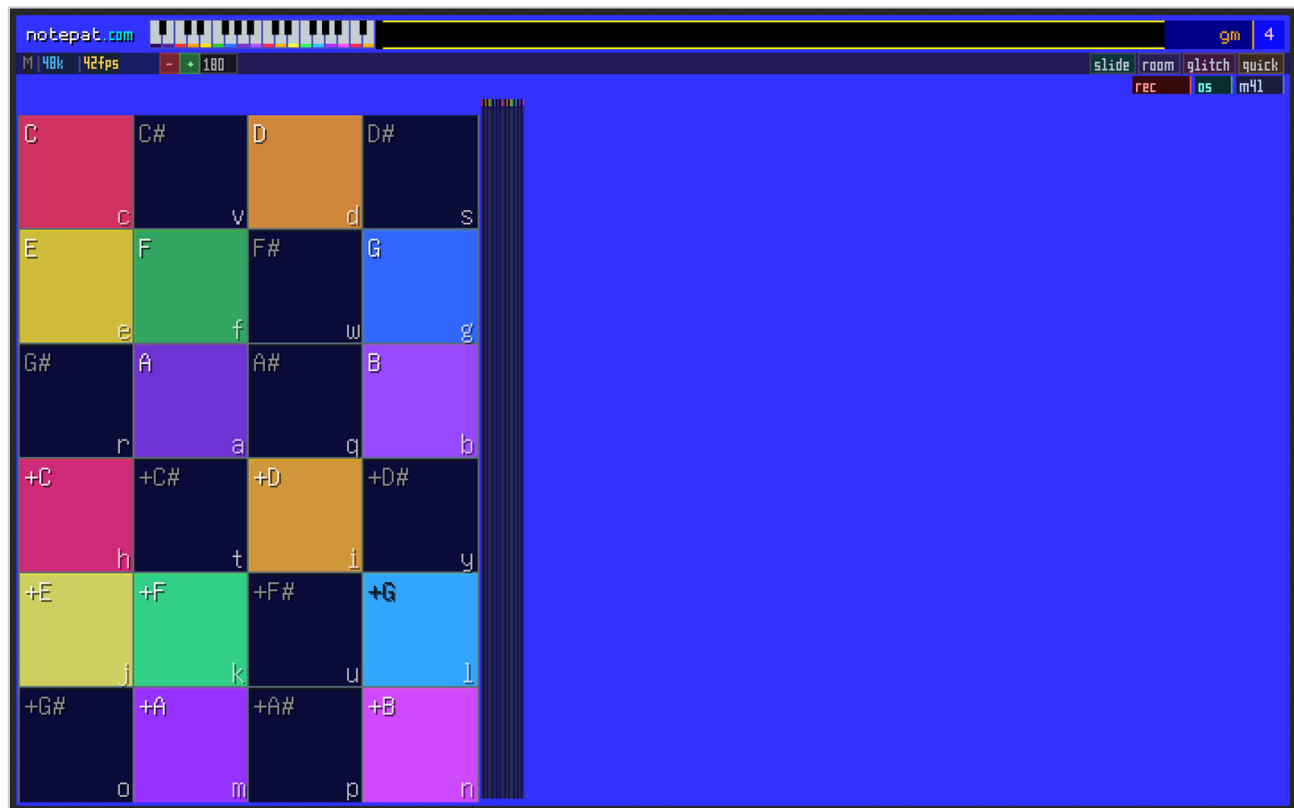


AC Native OS re-founding the personal computer · 2025–

author

aesthetic.computer

A bare-metal Linux that boots any surplus laptop into the creative instrument in about seven seconds, with your identity living in the boot partition rather than a cloud login. A retired fifty-dollar ThinkPad becomes a personal computer you own outright — and drops the cost of a networked laptop ensemble by two orders of magnitude, putting a planetary laptop orchestra within reach.

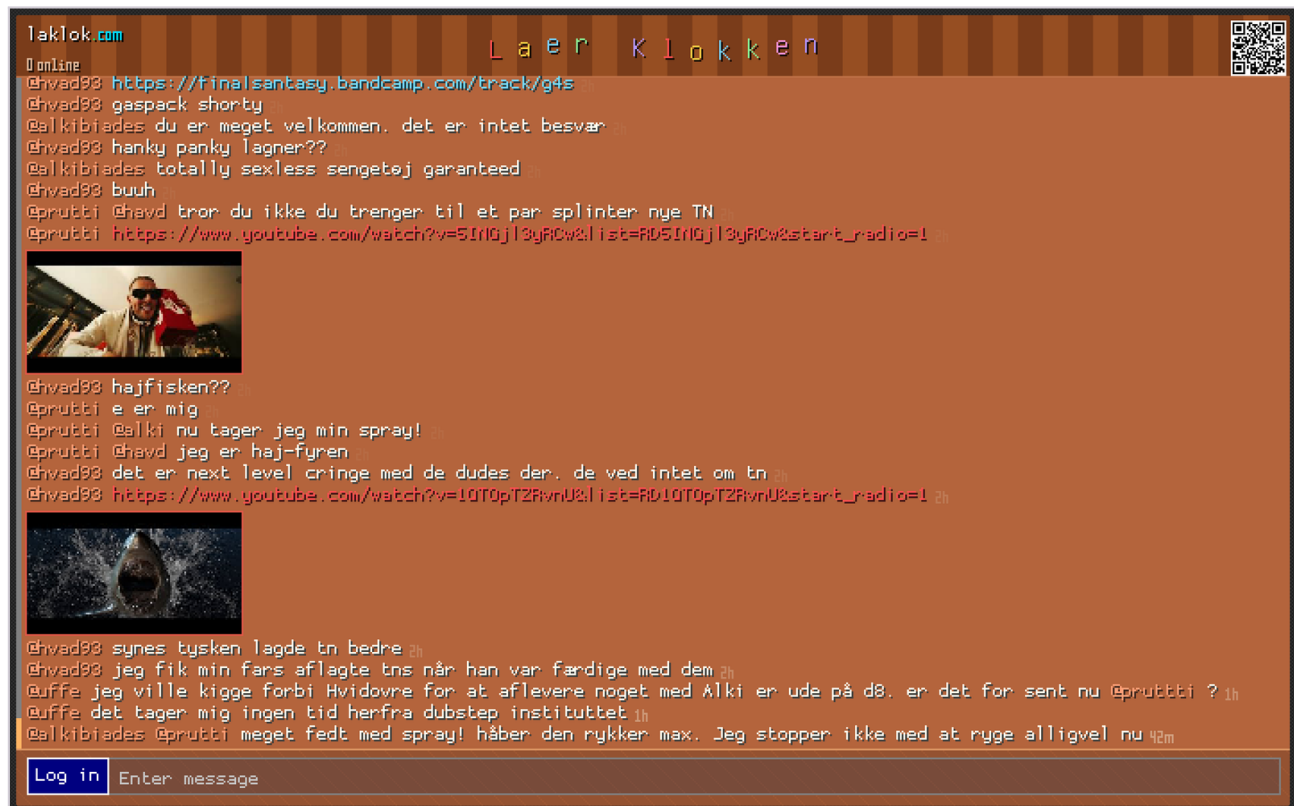


notepat instrument · 2024

author

aesthetic.computer/notepat

A musical instrument that turns a computer or phone keyboard into a playable, shareable score — tunes you can type, so a song is something you write down and pass along. It is open-source, lives at a web address, and reached the front page of Hacker News: a tool built for other people to depend on and make their own work with.



laklok the social layer · 2024–

author

aesthetic.computer/laklok

A live, public chat room that is itself an Aesthetic Computer piece — messages, images, and links shared in real time at its own web address. The everyday social layer of the commons, where a community gathers, talks, and passes work back and forth. The proposal's laptop orchestra grows out of rooms exactly like this one.



The Longest Whistlegraph Ever (so far) 2022 · New Museum (Rhizome commission)

co-creator, performer

sites.rhizome.org/the-longest-whistlegraph-ever-so-far

Live, social drawing performed with Camille Klein and Alex Freundlich as Whistlegraph, premiered at the New Museum. A whistlegraph is an audio-visual work performed by hand — drawing and singing a reproducible score into a poetic image. The performance-and-community lineage behind building tools people gather around and play together.